

VIP NOTEBOOK

Author: Elizabeth Yang

@January 15, 2025

- Introduction to VIP
- Brief overview of teams

IPCCrowd Fall 2024 PPT - Key Points:



Problem & Solution Overview

Core Features & Goals

1. Matching Algorithm

- Students fill out a survey on study habits
- AI matches them based on shared courses, learning styles, and availability
- Compatibility scores help students choose study partners
- Potential future use of LLM for more nuanced group formation

2. Facilitating Interactions

- AI-driven matching like a dating app
- AI-generated icebreakers & re-engagement prompts to sustain conversations
- Smart scheduling suggests optimal meeting times based on student schedules

3. Managing & Sharing Resources

- AI-powered system encourages resource sharing
- Badges/scores awarded to top contributors
- AI organizes content by topic & summarizes notes
- AI checks accuracy of uploaded resources

4. Extracting Value

- Upvote/downvote system for study materials
- AI-generated summaries & accuracy checks
- Ensure students can trust shared study resources

Questions:

- is this the product of the whole vip or just one team's?
 - what is the end goal of this project? Are we trying to publish an app?
-

@January 18, 2025

To Do List:

- ✓ Review the Class 1 PPT (COMPLETED 1/18)
- ✓ Review the teams and decide where I would like to be (COMPLETED 1/18)

Class 1 PPT - Key Points:



NOTES:

Grades:

- Letter Grades

Notebook:

- **To-Do Lists:**
 - Checkboxes
 - Date when listed
 - Log completion dates
- **Content to Include:**
 - Meeting notes & brainstorming ideas
 - Task progress, contributions, obstacles faced
 - Reflections on work & next steps
 - Interactions with teammates outside class

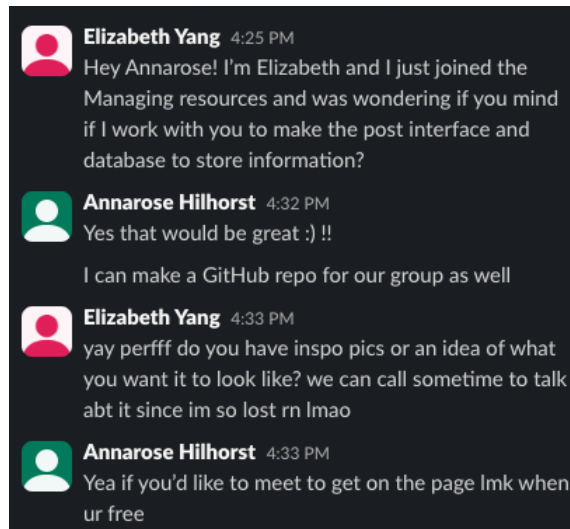
- Looked further into project teams
 - Reviewed purpose and aim of each team
- Decided team based on class spread
 - Needs Based — I found that many of the other teams had a much larger number of people within the sign ups
 - I felt that any of the teams would be interesting to join and did not have strong preferences for any specific team
 - My preferences:
 - Main languages: Python, Java
 - Area Preference: Backend, open to frontend but low experience

Questions:

- for to do list → do we do a weekly list? the example shows completion dates as different from the log dates
 - It makes more sense to me to have a weekly and a daily (since things may run over/get pushed?)
 - Note: I will try daily to do and maybe future to dos until first notebook check and then reevaluate if this works for me/ meets the requirements.

@January 21, 2025

- Online class due to weather
- Discussed what team we want to be on and why
- Reached out to Annarose Hilhorst to try to catch up to where the team is
 - Annarose Hilhorst - Teamleader (?) and preexisting VIP member



- Scheduled Call

Future To- Dos:

- ☐ Scope out the project more
- ☐ Figure out who is on the team

@January 23, 2025

Tasks:

- ☒ Call with Annarose Hilhorst (COMPLETED 1/23)
 - ☒ Discuss what we are making
 - ☒ Discuss what I can contribute

Notes from call:

- General Overview:
 - course resource-sharing platform
 - streamline resource discovery
 - encourage participation
 - establish credibility of shared materials (Karma)
- Annarose is planning on working on the UI
 - Seems like a good area to jump in

@January 28, 2025

Tasks:

- ☒ Scope out project more (COMPLETED 1/28)



Group Document:

Prototype goal & key features

- 1. How are you defining top contributions, users who need encouragement sharing, and posts that merit badges?**
 - a. Use a system based on viewer input likes, upvotes, etc.
 - b. Award System:
 - i. Course organizers can give awards like top contributor and merit badges
 - ii. Awards can also be given automatically through a certain number of likes/posts
 - iii. Leaderboard (points, upvotes, etc.)
 - c. Resource Credibility:
 - i. Can be approved by a moderator/teacher/TA
 - ii. Can be marked as useful by an AI model
- 2. What data will the prototype use to determine the above?**
 - a. User input (upvotes), course organizer input (contributions, badges)
- 3. Will AI be used to determine the above? If so, how?**
 - a. No
- 4. How will LLM be used to organize content by topic?**
 - a. No
- 5. Are you still planning to conduct sentiment analysis using LLM?**
 - a. Yes, to determine the quality of the resources that were uploaded.
 - b. etc.

User flows & wireframes

- 1. What are the user scenario(s)/user flow(s) that you want to demonstrate through the prototype?**
 - a. Uploading Resources
 - i. Uploading
 1. Pdf
 2. Website/links
 - ii. Tagging
 - iii. Interacting with users
 1. Commenting
 2. Receiving user input (likes, comments, answering)
 - b. Searching For Resources
 - i. Searching
 - ii. Providing user input
 1. Commenting
 2. Asking questions

3. Upvoting

2. Are you aiming for an interactive prototype or just a visual walk-through?

- a. Visual walk-through on Figma

Test data, data flow, dev environment

1. What data do you plan to use to test the prototype? (i.e., real or synthetic)

- a. Input data vs. Output data
- b. User prompts vs. System prompts

2. How are you going to obtain your dataset?

- a. Use questions and responses from smaller subreddits
- b. Material from open source courseware & websites

3. What is your target sample size and attributes of the dataset?

- a. 3-4 classes
- b. Multiple disciplines (eng, math, english, bio, etc)
- c. Multiple resource formats
 - i. Links
 - ii. PDF
 - iii. PPT
- d. Questions

Prototype testing

1. What do you want to test? Define clear and measurable objectives to ensure your test plan will yield actionable test results. For example:

- I want to test how well the algorithm/AI determines top contributors based on x, y, z measures;
- I want to test the quality of the prompts used to organize posts based on the AI that are in order of relevance.

Contributions

Annarose:

- Work on interactive UI (format to mesh with course organization)

Elizabeth:

- Find resources for classes
- Assist with Figma prototype

Teresa:

- Develop prototype on Figma
- Prompt engineering for AI to analyze documents

Erik

- Collecting data from existing platforms with similar features (open resources similar to piazza, edstem, etc.)
- Use LLM to assess quality of responses (usefulness)

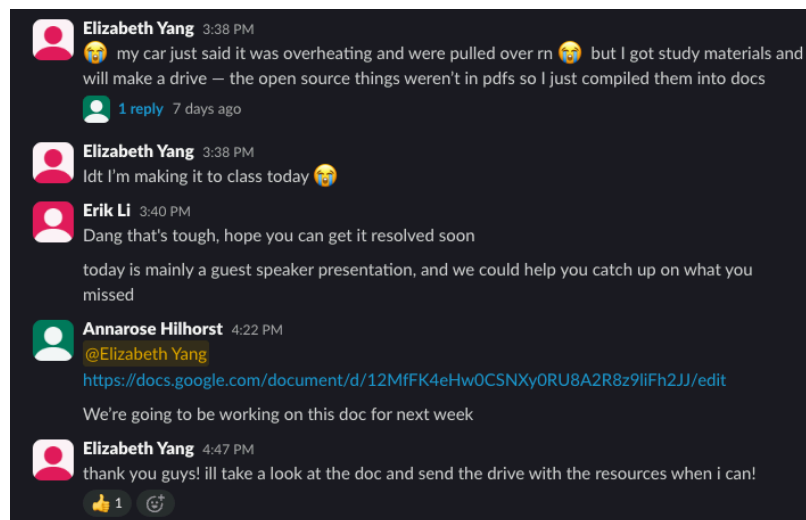
Abhiram

- Work on the resource credibility aspect
 - Use AI to check if the resource is credible based on syllabus, class material, etc. (any material that is uploaded)
- Use AI to recommend previous posts/class content/previously uploaded resources to people with questions

(this is all UI/figma)

@February 4, 2025

- Missed class - Car overheated : (



- caught up to speed — demos next week + work on prototype test plan
- Deadlines in slack
 - Notebook 2/7

Future To-Dos:

- ☐ Finish Compiling class documents
- ☐ Review Prototype Test Plan and start contributing

@February 7, 2025

Tasks:

- ☐ Finish Compiling class documents
- ☒ Review Prototype Test Plan and start contributing (COMPLETED 2/7)
- Found Open source classes:
 - Harvard Human Anatomy

- CS50
- American Government: Constitutional Foundations
- Compiled class notes into google docs since they were webpages that couldnt be linked without enrollment
- Ensured a set of different resource types (google doc/pdf, video, links)
- Looked at Prototype Test Plan and brainstormed:



Prototype Test Plan brainstorm:

1. Project Overview

Prototype description and purpose: The prototype is a course resource-sharing platform. It aims to streamline resource discovery, encourage participation, and establish credibility of shared materials.

Core features being tested:

- Uploading and tagging resources (PDFs, links, etc.)
- User interactions (commenting, upvoting, awards)
- Search functionality and relevance of results
- Leaderboard and award system functionality
- Resource credibility verification

Target user demographic:

- College students across different disciplines

Project constraints:

- Time: Limited testing and development time frame within the semester
- Resources: Finding acceptable resources

2. Test Questions & Objectives

Primary questions:

- How intuitive is the resource-uploading process?
- Do users engage with the platform (liking, commenting, awarding badges)?
- How well does the search function retrieve relevant resources?
- Is the credibility system effective and understandable?

Testing hypotheses:

- Users will be able to upload and tag resources
- Engagement will be intuitive with upvotes and comments
- AI-assisted credibility indicators will improve trust in shared materials.

5. Data Collection & Analysis

Documentation and collection methods:

- Notes, and survey responses

Data handling and storage procedures:

- Anonymized responses stored securely in a shared drive

Data synthesis and analysis approach/tools:

- Thematic analysis for qualitative feedback
- Statistical analysis for quantitative results

Future to dos:

- ☐ Finish prototype Test plan with group
- ☐ Work on PPT for demo
- ☐ Finish compiling the class notes

@February 9, 2025

Tasks:

- ☒ ~~Finish compiling the class notes (COMPLETED 2/9)~~

Class Notes Photos:

My Drive > VIP Managing Resources ▾

Type ▾ People ▾ Modified ▾ Source ▾

Name ↑	Owner	Last modified ▾
 American Government: Constitutional Foundations	 me	Feb 10, 2025 me
 CS50	 me	Feb 6, 2025 me
 Harvard Human Anatomy	 me	Feb 10, 2025 me

My Drive > VIP Managing Resources > American Government: ... ▾

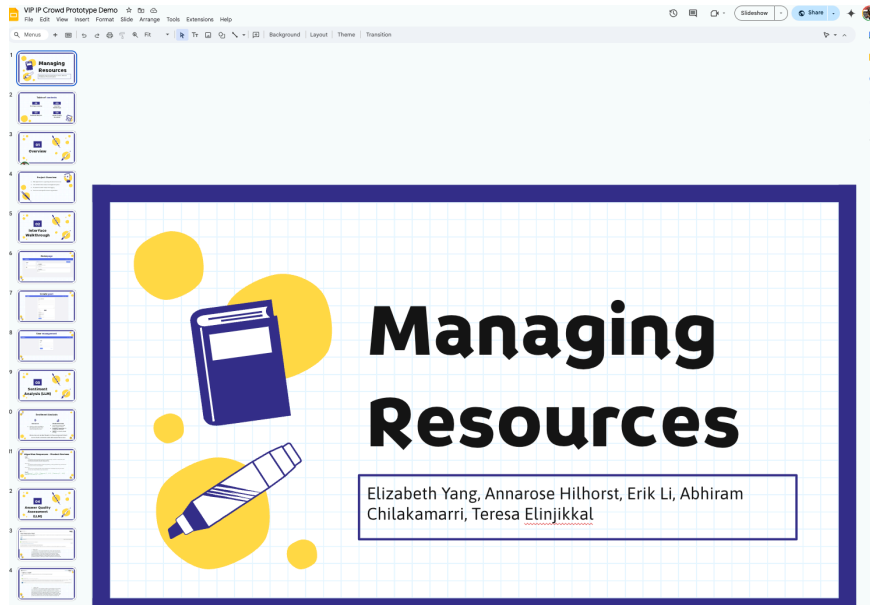
Type ▾ People ▾ Modified ▾ Source ▾

Name ↑	Owner	Last modified ▾	File
 Civil Liberty 📄	 me	Feb 10, 2025 me	85 B
 Civil Liberty.mp4 📹	 me	9:40 PM me	99.1 MB
 Federalism 📄	 me	Feb 10, 2025 me	727 B
 Federalism.mp4 📹	 me	Feb 10, 2025 me	167.1 MB
 Limited Government 📄	 me	Feb 10, 2025 me	4 KB
 Political Culture 📄	 me	Feb 10, 2025 me	364 B
 Representative Government 📄	 me	Feb 10, 2025 me	686 B
 RepresentativeGovernment.mp4 📹	 me	Feb 10, 2025 me	137.1 MB

@February 11, 2025

Tasks:

- ☒ ~~Work/Finalize on PPT for demo (COMPLETED 2/11)~~
 - Presented Powerpoint



Notes:

- Explore how applicable this is to large scale deployment
 - Intuitively it seems like a lot of power to be used as the system scales it would be exponential due to comparing to other resources
 - Dependency on the credibility system from user reactions could be useful
 - Thoughts: Perhaps continuously using the IIm to rank the credibility of sources may be a bit much with scaling
 - Youtube pushes videos based on audience interactions and other social medias do to — should we also lean heavily on this?

Thoughts:

- I think doing a weekly to do list may be nice to do and then adding them to certain days
 - Weekly To Dos
 - Day To Dos
- Potential issues: todos can come up by branching off of other tasks — how do we organize this since it may not be as straight forward with just a list (will try and see)
- Note to self: Export Notebook fro notion @ 70% size for formatting

Future to dos:

- ☒ ~~Finish prototype Test plan with group (Due Friday)~~

@February 18, 2025

- Class meeting/ work day
- Meetign notes:
 - testing tagging
 - testing quality of notes

@February 25, 2025

- worked on notes evaluation
- Challenge/why: to grade the quality of notes, we need a standardized way to evaluate them.
- We can evaluate the notes on clarity and detail so that there are clear and quantitative ways to “grade” the notes
 - Benchmarks for different ratings are clearly outlined with quantitative notes

Clarity	
	• 1 - Poor ◦ 7+ grammar/spelling mistakes ◦ 7+ Excessive complex terms without explanation ◦ Cannot be understood or followed • 2 - Fair ◦ 5-7 grammar/spelling mistakes ◦ 5-7 Excessive complex terms without explanation ◦ Very difficult to understand/requires significant effort understand • 3 - Good ◦ 3-4 grammar/spelling mistakes ◦ 3-4 undefined terms that need explanation ◦ The main points are understandable but require rereading to understand • 4 - Very Good ◦ 1-2 undefined terms that need explanation ◦ Most explanations are generally clear ◦ The message is easy to understand with minor effort • 5 - Excellent ◦ Undefined terms have explanation or definition ◦ The notes are easy to understand and logical organization
Detail	
	• 1 - Poor ◦ 5+ major concepts have vague details and ununderstandable ◦ Concepts have no explanations ◦ Vague/incomplete next steps for all methodologies • 2 - Fair ◦ 3-4 concepts are under-explained or not fully elaborated ◦ Lacks any examples or supporting data for important points ◦ Vague/incomplete next steps for 5-7 methodologies • 3 - Good ◦ Missing 1-2 key details, but most major points are addressed ◦ 1-2 concepts are underexplained ◦ Vague/incomplete next steps for 3-5 methodologies • 4 - Very Good ◦ All key points are covered with sufficient detail, missing only minor facts ◦ 1-2 examples or supporting data are included, providing adequate explanation ◦ Vague/incomplete next steps for 1-3 methodologies • 5 - Excellent ◦ All key facts and details are included with thorough explanations ◦ Major concepts are with 3+ supporting examples or pieces of data ◦ Specific next steps for methodologies

@February 28, 2025

- We will need exemplary notes to better understand what the different ratings really looks like
- Developed notes for Harvard CS50 course with 3 different ratings to help differentiate between ratings

Lecture 0 Notes (Clarity: 1, Detail: 1)

- cs50 class ppl new
- not about vs others, just self
- cs think solve prob
- input → output → compute
- 1, 0, bin, dec, num stuff
- ascii 65, unicode idk
- algo, step do thing
- phonebook, look mid, find? yes/no, go left/right, repeat?
- $n/2$, $\log_2 n$, math idk
- func, cond, bool, loop, stuff
- AI talk, hi = hi, bye = bye, else idk
- cs50.ai, dev, scratch fun?
- code `print(hi)`

Lecture 0 Notes (Clarity: 1, Detail: 3)

- cs50 many no exp cs b4
- imp not vs others but vs self growth

CS

- think, solve
- input → output

Numbers

- unary 1
- bin 2 digit
- dec 10 digit
- 123 100 10 1, math stuff
- ASCII 65 A
- Unicode big number

Algo

- steps for comp, find name mid book, if yes call, if no left/right, repeat
- $n/2$ $\log_2 n$

Code

- func, args, return, loops, bool, condition
- `AI say hi if hi, else bye if bye, else ??`
- AI cs50 vs non cs50?

Tools

- cs50.dev, vs code cs50
- scratch, fun?

Ratings & Justifications:

Clarity: 1 (Poor)

- Sentences are incomplete and lack structure.
- Words are missing, making it unreadable.
- Uses abbreviations without explanation.
- No logical flow between topics.

Detail: 1 (Poor)

- Major concepts are vague or missing.
- No definitions or examples.
- No explanations of how things work.
- Lacks depth, making it useless for studying.

Ratings & Justifications:

Clarity: 1 (Poor)

- Grammar and sentence structure are broken and incoherent.
- Concepts are listed without explanation or connection.
- Use of abbreviations and missing words makes it unreadable.
- Random math symbols without context ("123 100 10 1, math stuff").
- AI section is completely unclear ("AI cs50 vs non cs50?").

Detail: 3 (Good)

- Major topics are briefly mentioned.
- Missing key explanations but covers most concepts.
- Lacks examples and supporting data.
- Some methodologies are unclear, but main ideas are touched on.

Lecture 0 Notes (Clarity: 5, Detail: 5)

Introduction to CS50

- Many students taking CS50 have no prior computer science experience.
- The course focuses on individual growth rather than competition with peers.

Fundamentals of Computer Science

- **Computer Science** involves computational thinking and problem-solving.
- **Computational thinking**: The ability to break problems into smaller, logical steps.
- **Problem-solving**: Using algorithms and logical reasoning to solve complex tasks.
- **Basic computing model**: Information flows through a system as **input** → **processing** → **output**.

Number Systems & Data Representation

- **Unary (Base-1)**: Simplest number system, uses only one symbol (e.g., tally marks).
- **Binary (Base-2)**: Represents numbers using only 0s and 1s (bits). Example: 101 in binary = 5 in decimal.
- **Decimal (Base-10)**: The standard number system, using digits 0-9.
- **Binary to Decimal Conversion Example**:
 - 101 in binary = $1 \times 2^2 + 0 \times 2^1 + 1 \times 2^0 = 4 + 0 + 1 = 5$
- **ASCII & Unicode**:
 - ASCII assigns numerical values to characters (e.g., 'A' = 65).
 - Unicode expands character encoding to support multiple languages.

Algorithms & Efficiency

- **Definition**: A sequence of steps to solve a problem.
- **Example**: Searching for a name in a phone book efficiently:
 - Open to the middle.
 - If **name** is on the page, call.
 - If **name** is earlier, search the left half; if later, search the right half.
 - Repeat until found (binary search).
- **Efficiency**: Binary search reduces search time from n to $\log_2(n)$ steps.

Programming Concepts

- **Functions**: Reusable blocks of code with inputs (arguments) and outputs (return values).
- **Conditionals**: Allow decision-making in code using **if, else if, else**.
- **Boolean Expressions**: True/False statements used for logic.
- **Loops**: Repeat actions efficiently (**for, while**).

Ratings & Justifications:

Clarity: 5 (Excellent)

- Every concept is clearly defined and explained in a logical manner.
- No unnecessary jargon or undefined terms.
- Smooth transitions between topics.
- Examples provided for better understanding.

Detail: 5 (Excellent)

- Covers all major topics thoroughly.
- Provides multiple examples, such as binary conversion and phone book search.
- Explains reasoning behind concepts (e.g., efficiency of binary search).
- Gives practical applications of AI, programming, and tools used in CS50.

Artificial Intelligence & Large Language Models

- AI can make decisions based on user input:
 - If a student says "hello," respond with "hello."
 - If a student says "goodbye," respond with "goodbye."
 - More complex AI can respond based on different contexts and inputs.

CS50 Tools & Resources

- **CS50 Duck (cs50.ai)**: AI-powered assistant for debugging and learning.
- **CS50.dev**: Online development environment for writing and running code.
- **Scratch (scratch.mit.edu)**: A visual programming tool for learning fundamentals.

@March 2, 2025

- worked on the presentation to assist with explaining the "grading" of the notes to the class
- Worked with teammates to ensure the "grades" for the notes came out and were understandable

Rubric

First step in evaluating notes

Clarity

- **1 - Poor**
 - 7+ grammar/spelling mistakes
 - 7+ Excessive complex terms without explanation
 - Cannot be understood or followed
- **2 - Fair**
 - 5-7 grammar/spelling mistakes
 - 5-7 Excessive complex terms without explanation
 - Very difficult to understand/requires significant effort understand
- **3 - Good**
 - 3-4 grammar/spelling mistakes
 - 3-4 undefined terms that need explanation
 - The main points are understandable but require rereading to understand
- **4 - Very Good**
 - 1-2 undefined terms that need explanation
 - Most explanations are generally clear
 - The message is easy to understand with minor effort
- **5 - Excellent**
 - Undefined terms have explanation or definition
 - The notes are easy to understand and logical organization

Detail

- **1 - Poor**
 - 5+ major concepts have vague details and understandable
 - Concepts have no explanations
 - Vague/incomplete next steps for all methodologies
- **2 - Fair**
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Example 1 (not pass):

Lecture 0 Notes (Clarity: 1, Detail: 1)

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Detail: 1 (Poor)

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Example 2 (pass):

Lecture 9 Notes (Clarity: 5, Detail: 5)

Introduction to CS50

- Many students taking CS50 have no prior computer science experience
- The course focuses on individual growth rather than competition with peers.

Fundamentals of Computer Science

- Computer Science involves computational thinking and problem-solving.
- Computational thinking: The ability to break problems into smaller, logical steps.
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Detail: 5 (Excellent)

- Covers all major topics thoroughly.
- Provides multiple examples, such as binary conversion and phone book search.
- Explains reasoning behind concepts (e.g., efficiency of binary search).
- Gives practical applications of AI, programming, and tools used in CS50.

Output Examples:

Evaluate Notes

Evaluation Results

Clarity Score: 3/5

Terms need better definitions

How to improve:

- Define technical terms when first used
- Explain abbreviations
- Add examples for complex concepts

Detail Score: 3/5

Missing step-by-step explanations

How to improve:

- Add step-by-step procedures
- Explain how processes work
- Break down complex operations

Evaluate Notes

Reset

Evaluation Results

Clarity Score: 5/5

Detail Score: 5/5

Evaluation Rubric

Clarity (1-5)

- Grammar and spelling accuracy
- Term definitions and explanations
- Overall comprehension ease

Detail (1-5)

- Concept coverage
- Supporting examples
- Methodology explanations

@March 4, 2025

- Worked on slides and addressing Moon's comments



- evaluate the llms ability to provide a ranking system
- how do the prompts perform. limit it to a topic we ourselves know well and can assess.
- try to analyze shakespeare (public domain)
- problem encountered:
 - there is no "ground truth" in documents for the quality analysis, i think we should lean more on sentiment analysis for assessing quality.llms are computationally expensive at application level.
since llms are non deterministic and have varying response temperature.

- Coordinated slides with Abhiram
 - "grades notes with the rubric
 - Created a UI that returns the results for the user to see
 - Finalized slides

@March 11, 2025

- Evaluated the use of only using the rubric to evaluate resources
 - Pros:
 - objective
 - small scale topics aren't neglected
 - provides feedback
 - Cons:
 - As resources increase, comparing resources to each other can be resource heavy
- Using the rubric to evaluate the resources as a prerequisite to then comparing to other resources is a good way to bottleneck to help with resources
- We may have to depend on the user upvotes and downvotes on more resource intensive topics

March 17 - March 21

- Spring break

@March 25, 2025

Speaker Notes:

- Augmenting Transactive Memory
 - Not particularly researched in (3 studies)
 - Study notes:
 - found a bias towards louder people rather than those who were more knowledgeable
 - Use of AI increased performance → once taken away, performance goes down
 - Familiarity between members → better performance

- Brainstorming:
 - Expert Recommendation systems
 - map out project ideas and details map style(obsidian inspired) → the concepts can be used to search through other research fellow's work to connect people/present potential resources

@April 1, 2025

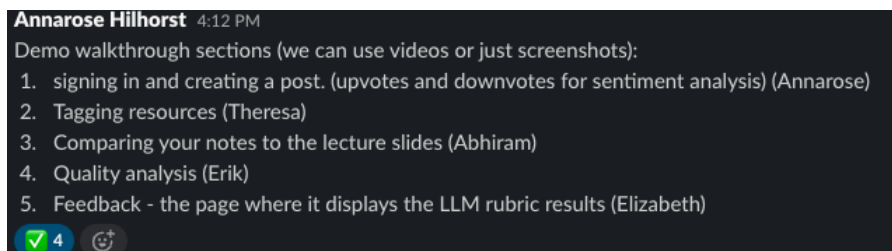
- Added more test data (notes from additional courses) to validate the rubric's scalability
- Asked other college students what they thought about the rubric
 - Feedback:
 - generally good
 - concerns about replicated notes since we dont check for that in the rubric
 - How would we confirm everything is correct (LLMs can be wrong about things)
 - it have very quantifiable ways to grade but the threshold would apply to all notes despite length (1 page with 3 errors vs 100 pages with 3 errors should be evaluated differently)

@April 4, 2025

- Brainstormed ideas to resolve feedback given
- How would we confirm everything is correct (LLMs can be wrong about things)
 - Instructors can verify that the data is wrong
 - We may have to depend on user input (upvotes/downvotes + comments) for larger topics
- it have very quantifiable ways to grade but the threshold would apply to all notes despite length (
 - updated the rubric to apply these thresholds to every 3 pages so that they would be fair for longer documents

@April 8, 2025

- Worked on final presentation



- Divided up work and slides

@April 14, 2025

- Worked on practicing what to talk about for the final showcase
- Focus points:
 - rubric provides a objective way to evaluate notes

- grading by rubric before any further